

SNAKE PLANT

Sansevieria trifasciata

This is probably the toughest houseplant you can buy—it's low maintenance, tolerant of neglect, and a hardworking air purifier. It also has an interesting form, with its upright swordlike foliage and fascinating variegated leaf markings, that will provide a positive mental distraction from your worries.

“I’m a low-maintenance delight for beginners.”

Help me thrive



POSITION

This plant will grow well in a sunny position but will also tolerate some shade. It can handle the dry air in our homes as well as more humid spots.



POTTING

Repot into the next size up when roots are growing through the bottom of the pot or circling inside. Use a free-draining, gritty compost.



GROWTH RATE

This is slow growing but will grow faster if its compost is replaced regularly. It can reach up to 4ft (1.2m) and spread to 1½ft (50cm).



CARE

Let the soil dry out between waterings. Feed once in spring and once in summer with a liquid houseplant fertilizer. Keep leaves free of dust.



I'll remove toxins

I can help reduce the damaging health effects of trichloroethylene, a chemical compound that is found in some household degreasing cleaning products, which can cause nausea with high levels of exposure. I also remove carbon dioxide and produce oxygen throughout the night.



Let's make babies

You can propagate me by snipping off a healthy leaf that's about 2in (5cm) long and inserting the base of the cutting into a free-draining gritty compost or just water. You can also grow new plants from division, where you take me out of my pot and split me up.

